

PROGRESSION • TIMELINE • SERIES

kanban

Kanban board — columns of cards by stage.

The board tracks cards across lanes.



KANBAN KEYLINE

keyline rules the lanes apart.

BACKLOG

Ruled lanes

S

IN PROGRESS

Same board

M

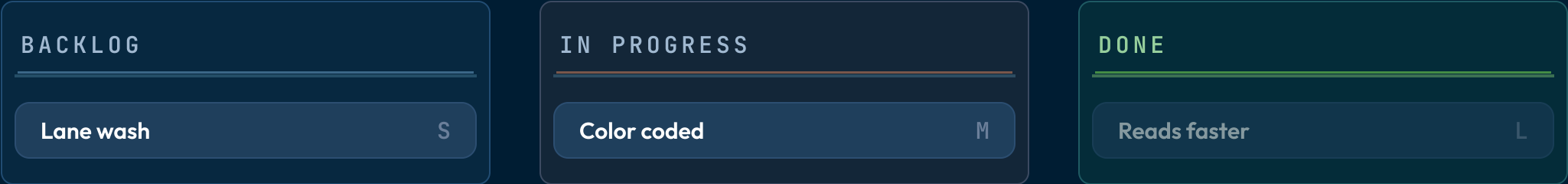
DONE

New look

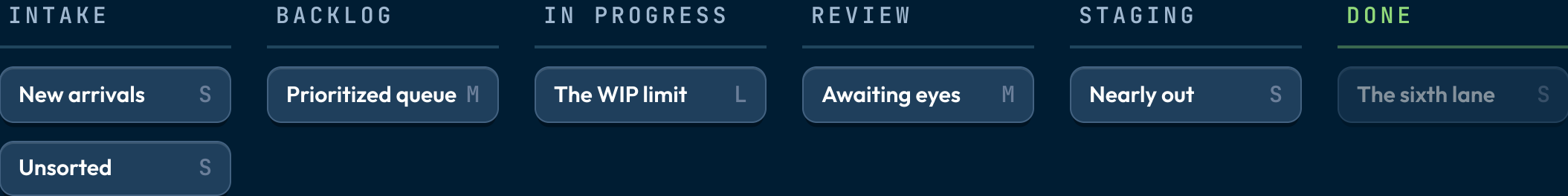
L

KANBAN TINTED

tinted colors each lane's wash.



Six lanes is the board's hard ceiling.



The board tracks cards across lanes.



The board tracks cards across lanes.

BACKLOG

Waiting cards

S

IN PROGRESS

The active limit

M

REVIEW

Almost done

S

DONE

Shipped work

L

The board tracks cards across lanes.



When NOT to reach for kanban.

Schedule, not status

If the question is when each task ships rather than where it sits today, reach for `gantt` (spans) or `roadmap` (phases). Kanban is a snapshot, not a timeline.

More than five lanes

Past five columns the cards compress and the column headers crowd. Group adjacent stages or split into two boards (e.g. by team) instead.

Cards without meta

A board of bare titles wastes the layout's affordances. Add at least a size badge and a lane label so the audience can scan workload and ownership at a glance.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`gantt` — schedule of overlapping tasks across lanes, not current state

`roadmap` — phased grid of deliverables across workstreams

`checklist` — single list of items with done/in-flight/planned states

`verdict-grid` — options scored against shared criteria, not stage-tracked